

Lions backup QB Teddy Bridgewater officially retires, replaced by Josh Dobbs



Teddy Bridgewater was on his third stint with the Lions before the announcement Sunday that he was leaving the team. Junfu Han / Imagn Images



By **Colton Pouncy**

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Detroit Lions quarterback Teddy Bridgewater is retiring from the NFL, [he announced](#) Monday on Instagram. On Sunday, coach Dan Campbell told reporters that the backup QB was stepping away from the team. The Lions placed Bridgewater on the reserved/retired list following Campbell's comments.

“I’ve known Teddy a long time,” Campbell said. “Man, the human being is unbelievable. Certainly the player. Everything that he’s about, the type of teammate he is, the way he prepares, always played the game up here and has a huge heart. He’s gonna be missed.”

Bridgewater was one of three QBs in camp with the Lions. To offset Bridgewater’s decision, the Lions are [signing veteran Josh Dobbs](#). That makes the team’s QB room: Goff, rookie UDFA Luke Altmyer and Dobbs, who will be playing for his seventh team since coming into the league in 2018.

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The 33-year-old Bridgewater was drafted by the Minnesota Vikings in 2014. He’s had stints with the New York Jets, New Orleans Saints, Carolina Panthers, Denver

Broncos, Miami Dolphins, Tampa Bay Buccaneers and Lions in his career, and was on his third stint with Detroit.

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Campbell said he will always remember Bridgewater for keeping the Saints afloat during the 2019 season. Drew Brees missed five games with a torn UCL in his throwing hand that year. Campbell, an assistant head coach and TEs coach for the Saints then, watched Bridgewater step in and lead the team to a 5-0 record. He earned Campbell's trust.

The Lions signed Bridgewater ahead of the 2023 season, where he was a resource for Jared Goff and a mentor to young players like Jameson Williams. After retiring in 2024 to coach high school football in Miami, Bridgewater returned to the NFL for a late-season stint with the Lions. He briefly filled in for Goff in Detroit’s playoff loss to the Washington Commanders, leading the team to a scoring drive in his lone series.

Colton Pouncy is a staff writer for The Athletic covering the Detroit Lions. He previously covered Michigan State football and basketball for the company, and covered sports for The Tennessean in Nashville prior to joining The Athletic.

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